

A Minor Project Proposal Report on

**Flint Secure: Real-Time Fraud Detection and Device  
Intelligence Platform**

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the Degree of **Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Engineering**  
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## ABSTRACT

Nepal's digital payments are growing fast, but many payment providers still use simple fixed rules that miss organised fraud. SIM swap attacks increased sharply in recent years [1], and banks face stronger compliance checks. This project proposes **Flint Secure**: a fraud and device-intelligence service that Nepali providers can host themselves. The team will build a Go-based API and Go background workers with Redis, NATS, and PostgreSQL. Two main services are planned: a **device identification API** using a three-step fingerprint match, and a **transaction scoring API** using seven risk factors plus SIM-swap safety rules. A web SDK will collect device signals safely on the client side. The expected outcome is faster, clearer fraud decisions (ALLOW, FLAG, or BLOCK), with scoring designed to stay under 50 ms for most requests and about 3,200 requests per second in load tests. Success will be checked using k6 load scripts and roughly 168 automated test cases (at least 92% pass rate), as required for the minor project.

**Keywords:** fraud detection, device fingerprinting, risk scoring, payment service provider, SIM swap, behavioral profiling, Go, Redis, NATS, PostgreSQL, fintech, Nepal, API security

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# 1 Problem Statement

In the last five years, mobile wallets such as eSewa, Khalti, and IME Pay have grown quickly in Nepal. The Nepal Rastra Bank reports more than ten million mobile-banking users (2024). More users means more fraud risk. Most payment service providers (PSPs) still block fraud with simple rules (for example, a maximum amount or a daily limit) that cannot catch organised attacks.

Three main gaps motivate this project:

1. Rules are updated manually and do not adapt to new attacks such as SIM swap, stolen passwords, or fake devices.
2. Transactions are not linked to a stable device, so one phone used for many accounts (money-mule behaviour) stays hidden.
3. Systems rarely learn normal user habits (typical amounts, usual hours, usual recipients), so fraud is noticed only after money is lost.

FIU-Nepal reports a large year-on-year rise in SIM swap fraud [1]. Nepal's FATF grey-list status also pushes banks to improve monitoring. When controls are weak, fraud is missed; when rules are too strict, honest customers are blocked and providers lose business.

## 2 Project Objectives

### 2.1 Main Objective

The **main objective** is to **design, implement, and test** Flint Secure: a real-time fraud and device-intelligence platform for Nepali PSPs. The platform will provide stable device identification across browser or app updates, risk scoring with SIM-swap protection, and measurable speed targets (95% of score requests under 50 ms and about 3,200 requests per second in planned load tests). A large automated test suite (about 168 cases, at least 92% pass) will be used to verify behaviour. Build steps and validation are described in Sections 5 and 6.

## 3 Significance of the Study

International tools such as Stripe Radar, Sift, and Sardine are strong but costly for typical Nepali wallet volumes and are not tuned for local problems like SIM swap. Flint Secure is significant because it will offer **affordable, local** fraud infrastructure using open software (Go, Redis, NATS, PostgreSQL) that a PSP can run on low-cost cloud hardware. The project will also show that a minor-project team can meet clear performance and security targets suitable for a pilot deployment.

## 4 Literature Study/Review

This section reviews prior work on device fingerprinting, payment fraud, velocity checks, mobile account takeover, and the Nepali context. It supports the design in Section 5. Together, these subsections form more than 15% of the proposal text, as expected for a proper literature review.

### 4.1 *Device Fingerprinting and Identity Stability*

Eckersley [2] showed that browser signals can identify devices without cookies. Laperdrix et al. [3] used canvas and graphics rendering to trace hardware differences; this idea will guide our first-level fingerprint in the SDK. Vastel et al. [4] studied how fingerprints change after updates; their work supports our planned three-step server match: exact hash, recovery by stored device ID, then fuzzy comparison when the fingerprint drifts. Separating device identification from transaction scoring keeps the payment path fast.

### 4.2 *Statistical and Machine-Learning Fraud Detection*

Bolton and Hand [5] reviewed statistical fraud methods and ranked velocity features (how often, how much, and to whom money moves) among the best real-time indicators. We will store these counts in Redis for quick lookup on each score request. West and Bhattacharya [6] surveyed machine-learning fraud systems; ensembles often work better, but banks also need simple, explainable rules. Fiore et al. [7] discussed handling rare fraud cases when training data is small. Dal Pozzolo et al. [8] explained how to calibrate risk scores into clear bands. For this semester we will use **rule-based scoring** with published weights; machine learning is not planned for this semester's deliverable.

### 4.3 *Mobile Account Takeover and National Context*

Mjaaland et al. [9] described SIM swap attacks on mobile banking. Combined with FIU-Nepal findings [1], this justifies strong phone-to-device checks in our scoring model. Better monitoring also supports national compliance goals, not only private profit for one company.

### 4.4 *Commercial Platforms and Research Gap*

Stripe Radar, Sift, and Sardine offer mature cloud APIs, but per-transaction pricing and foreign calibration limit their use for many Nepali PSPs. Auditors also prefer transparent rules. Flint Secure will fill this gap with **open, self-hostable** software and weights adjusted using local fraud reports [1], payment statistics, and a planned pilot data set (see Section 6).

## 5 Proposed Methodology

This section explains **how** the system will be built: process, tools, main steps, and design diagrams (Figures 1 and 2).

### 5.1 *Software Development Life Cycle*

We will follow an **Agile** plan with two-week sprints (Table 2). Each sprint will end with testable code and a short supervisor meeting (NCIT Appendix B log).

### 5.2 *Tools and Technologies*

The planned stack includes Go with the chi router, two Redis instances, PostgreSQL, NATS JetStream, Go workers, a JavaScript web SDK, Docker Compose for local testing, k6 for load tests, and deployment on any VPS or cloud provider available to the team.

### 5.3 *Repository Structure and Implementation Phases*

Code will be organised in a single repository with folders for the API, workers, web SDK, and database migrations. Work will proceed in phases:

#### 5.4 *Phase 1: Infrastructure and Middleware*

**Step 1: Databases and messaging.** Set up PostgreSQL for clients, keys, transactions, and alerts; Redis for devices and speed-sensitive counters; NATS for events such as new devices and scored payments.

**Step 2: Security middleware.** Each API call will pass checks for request ID, client IP, location lookup (GeoIP), API key, rate limits, and optional signed requests to stop replay attacks.

#### 5.5 *Phase 2: Device Identification API*

**Step 3: Web SDK.** The web SDK will collect device signals, hash them on the client, and call the device identification API.

**Step 4: Matching on the server.** The server will try, in order: (1) exact fingerprint match; (2) match by saved device ID if the fingerprint changed slightly; (3) fuzzy match among similar devices; (4) create a new device ID if none fit, then notify background workers.

#### 5.6 *Phase 3: Risk Scoring API*

**Step 5: Load risk data.** Before scoring, the API will read device trust, user habits, speed counters, recipient risk, and client settings from Redis in one batch.

**Step 6: Calculate score.** A single scoring function (no database calls inside it) will combine seven factors (device, amount, time, speed, network, identity, and recipient) and return a score from 0 to 100 with ALLOW, FLAG, or BLOCK. Hard rules will force BLOCK for clear SIM swap or datacenter abuse.

**Step 7: Background updates.** After the response is sent, the system will update speed counters and publish an event for workers without delaying the customer.

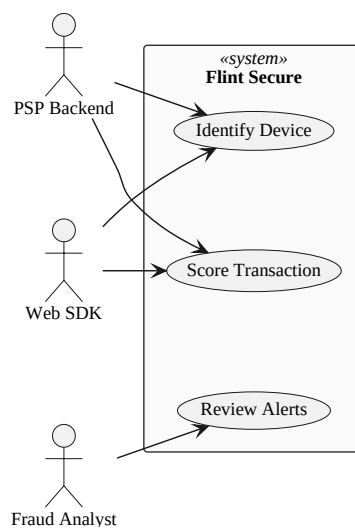
### 5.7 Phase 4: Workers and Deployment

**Step 8: Background workers.** Go worker services will save transactions, update user profiles, adjust device trust, and refresh settings in Redis.

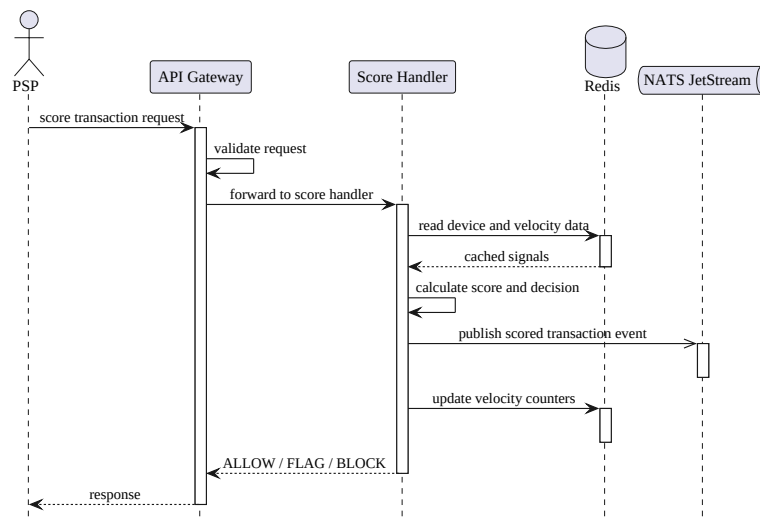
**Step 9: Deployment.** Docker Compose for development; pilot hosting on any VPS or cloud provider available, with HTTPS and health checks.

### 5.8 System Design Diagrams

Figures 1 and 2 summarise the proposed architecture.



**Figure 1:** Use case diagram: PSP backend, web SDK, and fraud analyst.



**Figure 2:** Sequence diagram: scoring flow with Redis and NATS JetStream.

## 6 Proposed Performance Analysis Methodology and Validation Scheme

The team will check the system with simple, repeatable tests (load runs and automated scripts), not one-off demos only. Table 1 summarises what will be measured.

| What we check        | How                        | Target                          |
|----------------------|----------------------------|---------------------------------|
| Scoring speed        | Short load test (k6)       | Most requests under 50 ms       |
| Traffic capacity     | Increase load step by step | About 3,200 requests per second |
| Device lookup speed  | API tests                  | Under 500 ms                    |
| Stability under load | Check error logs           | Very few server errors          |
| Overall behaviour    | Automated test suite       | At least 92% tests pass         |
| SIM swap safety      | Test a phone-number change | Block high-risk cases           |

**Table 1:** How the system will be tested (initial targets)

Demo at defenses will show ALLOW, FLAG, and BLOCK decisions on sample transactions.

## 7 Proposed Deliverable/Output

The planned deliverables are a **Go API**, a **web SDK**, supporting **documentation**, and background **workers** for processing and updates.

## 8 Project Task and Time Schedule

The team will follow the college semester and NCIT defense dates (proposal, mid-term, and final, with at least four weeks between defenses). The table below is only a rough plan; details will be updated with the supervisor in the meeting log.

| Phase          | Planned focus                  | Outcome           |
|----------------|--------------------------------|-------------------|
| Proposal       | Report, design, presentation   | Proposal defense  |
| Early semester | Setup and core development     | Working prototype |
| Mid-term       | Progress demo and report       | Mid-term defense  |
| Late semester  | Testing and refinement         | Stable demo       |
| Final          | Documentation and presentation | Final defense     |

**Table 2:** Indicative project schedule (initial proposal)



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